

Biology

Master of Science

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MISSION STATEMENT

The Master of Science program in Biology offers students opportunity for advanced learning in their chosen area of Biology. Our purpose is to train students broadly in modern biological principles so that they acquire the strong foundation needed to become highly skilled and intellectually independent scientists. The program is committed to excellence in education, research and service.

ADMISSION REQUIREMENTS

Please see the general graduate admission requirements [here](#). Specific requirements to this program are as follows:

1. Clear evidence of scholastic competence to meet the requirements for an advanced degree.
2. One year of chemistry, including one term of organic chemistry and or biochemistry.
3. Applicants who do not meet regular admission requirements may apply for conditional or provisional admission.

POLICY STATEMENT

1. The degree is a cooperative degree awarded by AAMU or UA Huntsville.
2. Initial registration may be at either institution.
3. As a requirement for a degree, each graduate teaching assistant must conduct one or more laboratory or lecture sections, as decided by his/her graduate advisory committee, in an area related to his/her field of specialization.
4. An advisory committee for an individual enrolled at one of the two schools shall have at least one representative from the other school.
5. Students will be admitted in accordance with admission criteria of the respective institutions.
 - a) Except for the purpose of taking courses, conducting research and other strictly academic matters, students will not be encouraged to transfer back and forth between schools (see "b" below).
 - b) Students will need to declare the school of intent (from which they wish to receive a degree) by the end of nine credit hours taken or by the end of their first academic term.
 - c) Thereafter, a student may not transfer between schools and must remain in the same area of emphasis.
 - d) Equipment and facilities at the two respective departments shall be available to all graduate students in the program without regard to the institution at which the students are enrolled.

DEGREE REQUIREMENTS

Students may choose a thesis option (Plan I), or non-thesis option (Plan II). The Biology Master of Science (M.S.) degree is

a 30/36 semester hour program, organized into four major components:

1. Core courses (6 hours). The biology graduate program aims to provide students with the concepts and skills needed to enter Ph.D. programs or professional programs and function effectively as biologists. All students enrolled in the Biology Program must complete the biology core. The core requirements consist of six credit hours in biology concept courses. These courses focus on the basic concepts of biological research, instrumentation and ethics.
2. Concentration hours for Thesis and Non-thesis options are 21 credit hours.
3. Master's Thesis (6 hours) or Master's Report (non-thesis) and a minimum of nine (9) elective course credit hours.
4. Elective courses may be chosen from any biology concentration area or biological science-related areas as approved by the student's major advisor and/or graduate committee.
5. Oral defense (thesis) or Comprehensive examination (non-thesis)

Thesis Option, Plan I

All candidates must satisfactorily complete a minimum of 27 credit hours of coursework (6ch core and 21ch concentration), 6 thesis hours, and submit and defend an acceptable thesis, which shows creative thinking and independent judgment in developing a problem from primary sources.

Non-thesis Option, Plan II

All candidates must satisfactorily complete a minimum of 36 credit hours of coursework (6ch core, 21ch concentration, 9ch electives), take the Comprehensive Examination and write an acceptable Master's Report to be submitted to the student's major advisor and departmental chair. The nature of the report can be a library search, survey, or experimentation as determined by the student's major advisor.

- Students must maintain the grade point averages and course grades noted on each curricula page for the program.